

encrypted. Encryption does not, however, stop deletion of the file or folder if the other user has the permission to do so.

So how do you encrypt a file? If you don't want to convert any FAT32 partitions to NTFS, there are many third party software available. Some of the free software available are DeltaCrypt OneClick, which works on all Windows platforms and uses powerful 1024-bit RSA protection, digital signatures and

unalterable public keys. Cryptainer LE encryption software uses the 128-bit Blowfish algorithm and a 256-bit implementation of AES. Cryptainer LE encrypts all the files that are dragged into the application window, which is also called a vault. P-Encryption Lite is also worth mentioning here, as it uses AES encryption.



Encrypting a folder

If you have FAT32 partitions and want to use XP's encryption feature, XP allows you change the filesystem without your losing any data. To convert a FAT32 disk or partition to NTFS, at the command prompt, type in

```
convert drive_letter: /fs:ntfs
```

Now that your filesystem is NTFS (if it wasn't already), let's get to the encryption. Open Windows Explorer. Select the file or folder you want to encrypt, right-click on it and go to 'Properties'. Now click 'Advanced'.

This will take you to another screen called 'Advanced Attributes'. Select the last checkbox and click 'OK'. If this is a parent folder, XP will ask if you also want to encrypt the sub-folders. Finally, click 'Apply'. The file or folder is now encrypted.